Ide 402 -Project1

ZENTEA

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1 — RITUAL & WELLNESS RESEARCH

Keywords
- Healing
- Ritual
- Wellness
- Tea culture
- Mindfulness

AI Role -Clarifier

Selected Prompt
What kinds of rituals are associated with healing or relaxation in different cultures?”

AI Response Summary
AI described several rituals where beverages play a role in relaxation and healing practices, especially tea rituals in Asian cultures.

Reflection
Tea rituals appeared as a meaningful starting point because they combine relaxation, preparation, and cultural practices.

Design Decision
Focus on tea preparation as a simplified healing ritual.

Accepted
Tea ritual concept.

Rejected
Generic hot beverage machines.

Transformed
Healing concept → tea ritual system

02 — HERBAL INGREDIENTS & TEA MODE SYSTEM

Keywords
- Herbal tea
- Functional blends
- Wellness drinks
- Tea modes

AI Role-Expander -

Selected Prompt
What herbs are commonly used for relaxation, digestion, energy, and focus?”

AI Response Summary
AI generated a list of herbal ingredients with different functional effects.Around 30 herbal ingredients were explored during research.

Reflection
Instead of allowing users to choose individual herbs, grouping them into functional tea modes simplified the interaction.

Design Decision
.Create tea modes based on common wellness needs.
- Relax
- Sleep
- Digest
- Energy
- Focus

Accepted
Mode based tea preparation.

Rejected
Complex ingredient customization on the machine.

Transformed
Ingredient complexity → simplified mode system.

03 — FORM EXPLORATION (MAIN DESIGN FOCUS)

Keywords
- Organic form
- Soft geometry
- Wellness aesthetics
- Calm design

AI Role-Critique

Selected Prompt
How can a tea machine avoid looking like a coffee machine?”

AI Response Summary
AI suggested exploring softer shapes and organic geometries instead of mechanical forms.

Reflection
Coffee machines communicate speed and pressure, which contradicts the calm ritual of tea preparation.
Because of this, many form explorations were created focusing on:
* soft surfaces
* smooth transitions
* rounded geometry
Sharp edges were intentionally avoided.

Design Decision
.Develop a calm and sculptural form language suitable for wellness environments.

Accepted
Organic design language.

Rejected
Coffee machine aesthetics.

Transformed
Machine object → wellness artifact.

04 — DISPLAY INTERACTION

Keywords
- Minimal interface
- Small display
- Guided interaction

AI Role--Clarifier

Selected Prompt
“What information is essential for a minimal beverage machine interface?”

Reflection
The machine should not feel overly technological.

Because most intelligence exists in the mobile application, the display remains minimal.

AI Response Summary
AI suggested limiting the interface to a few key functions.
- Mode selection
- Brewing progress
- Ready notification

Design Decision
..Use a small simple display instead of a large digital interface.

Accepted
Minimal UI.

Rejected
Large interactive screen.

Transformed
Smart system → calm interface.

05 — CLEANING & MAINTENANCE SYSTEM

Keywords
- Hygiene
- Flavor purity
- Cleaning system

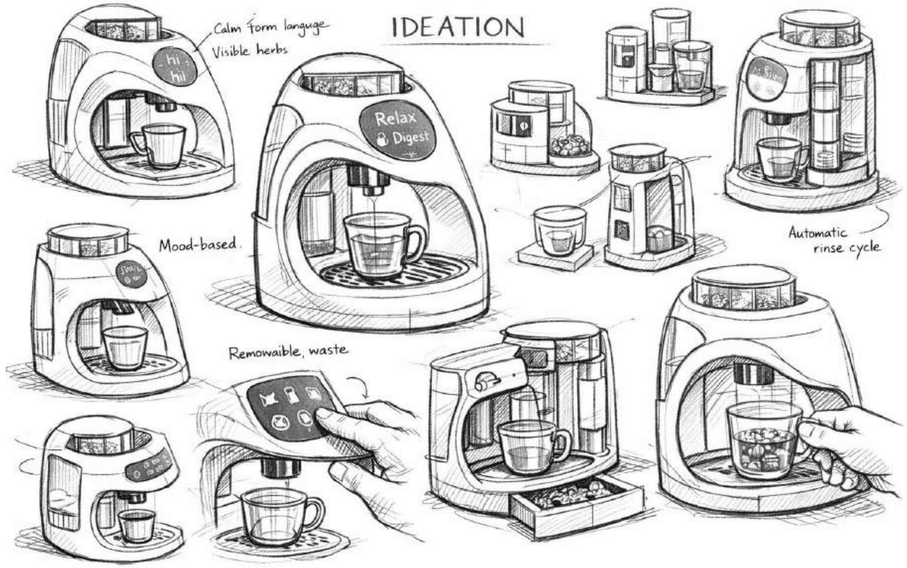
AI Role--Expander

Selected Prompt
““What mechanisms prevent flavor contamination in beverage machines?”

Reflection
Maintaining the purity of herbal flavors became a key design challenge.
Different teas should never mix residues.

AI Response Summary
AI suggested cleaning cycles and waste separation systems.

Design Decision
Implement:
- automatic cleaning cycle
- herb waste drawer
- internal flushing system



Accepted
Self-cleaning system.

Rejected
Manual cleaning.

Transformed
.Cleaning responsibility → automated maintenance.

06 — WATER SUPPLY SYSTEM

Keywords
- Water supply
- Maintenance
- Public environments

AI Role--Critique

Selected Prompt
“Is a water tank or direct tap connection better for beverage machines in public environments?”

Reflection
Water tanks require frequent refilling and maintenance.

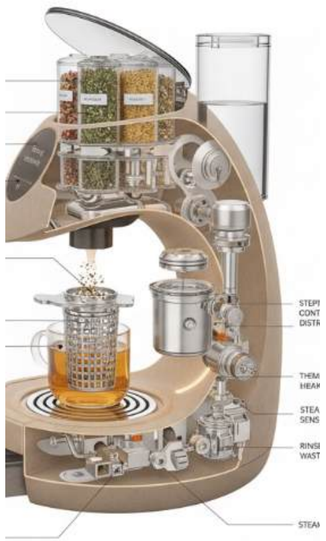
AI Response Summary
AI explained that direct tap systems reduce maintenance in high-use environments.

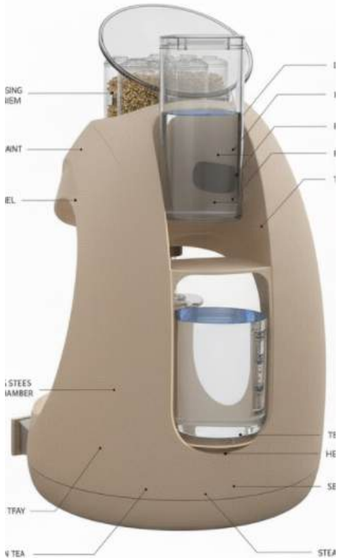
Design Decision
Switch to filtered tap water connection.

Accepted
Tap water system.

Rejected
Water tank.

Transformed
Refill system → continuous water supply.





Accepted
Tap water system.

Rejected
Water tank.

07 — HERB CHAMBER VISIBILITY DECISION

Keywords
- herb freshness
- aroma preservation
- ingredient visibility
- tea ritual
- controlled transparency

AI Role-Critique

Selected Prompt
“How does exposure to air and light affect the freshness of herbal tea ingredients?”

Reflection
Initially the design had fully visible herbs.
However, this would cause herbs to lose freshness and aroma faster.
Since aroma is a critical part of the tea ritual, the design needed to protect the ingredients.

AI Response Summary
AI explained that:
* herbs lose aroma when exposed to air
* light accelerates degradation
* sealed storage preserves flavour longer

Design Decision
The herb chamber was redesigned to be:
* mostly closed
* only partially visible
* protected from air and light
This preserves aroma and freshness.

Accepted
semi-closed herb chamber
limited transparency

Rejected
fully open herb containers

Transformed
..visual exposure → freshness preservation

Mode Selection Interface

Cup Placement and Mode Confirmation

Tea Brewing Process

Ready

The machine is in standby mode, ready to prepare tea.

The user checks the modes before taking any action and then places a cup on the machine.

The user selects a tea mode and starts brewing from the app.

The user continues their activity while the tea is brewing.

The user receives a notification that the tea is ready.

the machine returns to standby.